

Malware Removal & Performance Tuning (HP All-in-One)

1. Phase I: Pre-Remediation & Licensing

Before beginning the automated cleaning process, critical licensing data must be secured to ensure the client's paid subscriptions are preserved.

Verify McAfee Subscription

- Open the McAfee interface.
- Navigate to **Account > My Subscription**.
- **Action:** Document the registered email address. Modern McAfee licenses are entitlement-based rather than utilizing a local 25-digit key.

Verify Cloud Connectivity

Ensure the PC is online. Perform the standard Windows "Uninstall a Program" for McAfee. This allows the software to ping McAfee servers and "release" the license seat for later reinstallation.

DEEP CLEANUP: Run the McAfee Consumer Product Removal (MCPR) tool to strip remaining kernel-level drivers and registry hooks that interfere with deep-system scanning.

2. Phase II: Tron Script Configuration

Due to the hardware constraints of an older HP AIO with 8GB RAM and a mechanical HDD, the Tron script must be customized.

Download the full version of Tron here: <https://bmrfr.org/repos/tron>

Command Line Command: `tron.bat -a -sd -p`

Switch Definitions:

- **-a** (Automatic): Skips the manual "I AGREE" disclaimer and proceeds through stages without prompts.
- **-sd** (Skip Defrag): Mandatory for this unit; a full defrag on mechanical HDDs with poor thermals can lead to overheating and adds 4+ hours to runtime.
- **-p** (Preserve Power): Prevents the HP system from entering Sleep or Hibernation mode.

3. Phase III: Execution & Stages

- **Preparation:** Reboot the PC before launching. Ensure no Windows Updates are pending.
- **Launch:** Open an Elevated Command Prompt (Admin), navigate to the Tron folder, and execute the command string.

- **Stage 3 (Disinfect):** Malwarebytes will install and open a window. Tron will continue other scans (Sophos/Kaspersky) in the background. *Note: You may manually click "Scan" in the Malwarebytes window when convenient, but the rest of the script proceeds regardless.*

4. Phase IV: Final Optimization & Post-Clean

Manual steps to ensure "Fake Virus" pop-ups do not return:

1. **Browser Notification Reset:** Open Chrome/Edge settings, navigate to **Privacy and Security > Site Settings > Notifications**, and remove any unrecognized URLs in the "Allow" list.
2. **Reinstall Security Software:** Navigate to home.mcafee.com, log in using the email address recorded in Phase I, and run the installer. The subscription auto-activates based on hardware ID and account login.
3. **Thermal Verification:** Ensure the rear vents are clear of dust; mechanical drives are prone to failure during high-intensity scans in restricted airflow.

Data Preservation & Browser Integrity

Important: The process will not remove favorites (bookmarks) from Chrome or Edge.

- **Stage 1 (Tempclean):** Tron wipes temporary files, cookies, and browsing history to remove tracking files used by "fake pop-up" scripts.
- **What is Safe:** Favorites, Bookmarks, and Saved Passwords are stored in separate database files and are ignored by Tron.

Summary of Data Changes:

- **Removed:** Browsing History, Cookies, Cache, and Malicious Notifications.
- **Preserved:** Bookmarks, Favorites, and Saved Passwords.